HYBRID PARTICIPATION INNOVATION LAB · STEP 3 · 28 OCTOBER

Co-define the participatory challenge

The developers' problem is not the final problem

Next Wave

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1 · THE ORIGINAL FORMULATION

How the developers would frame it

> **"How can an AI assistant get tenants to shift their energy use to sunny hours, so the community earns the highest incentive?"**

HIDDEN ASSUMPTIONS

- Tenants are flexible and at home in the day
- A bigger incentive means a better project
- An app is enough to reach everyone
- An equal split of the money is fair
- Sharing home data is unproblematic
- Tenants are users, not decision-makers

2 · WHAT OTHERS MIGHT ADD OR CONTEST

Imagined voices from our stakeholder map

ELDERLY TENANT

"I don't use apps. Who explains this to me, and can I say no?"

SHIFT WORKER

"I'm never home when the sun shines. Why should I get less?"

MIGRANT PARENT

"Will it be in my language? Who will see when we are at home?"

TENANT UNION

"Benefits must not depend only on behaviour. Need matters."

ATER ROMA

"Who maintains the roof and the devices, and who is liable?"

TECH PROVIDER

"Without good data the AI can't forecast. How much data is enough?"

3 · HOW THE PROBLEM SHIFTS

From optimising tenants to designing with them

From (developers' view)	To (shared view)
Maximise the incentive	Share benefits in a way tenants find fair
Change tenants' behaviour	Fit the system to different routines
Equal split by default	A fairness rule decided together
App for everyone	App, paper, phone and a person
Collect all useful data	A data charter tenants approve
Automate appliances	Advise by default, automate only by choice

4 · OUR SHARED PARTICIPATORY QUESTION

Under what conditions can an AI energy assistant help the different households of a public housing complex share solar energy and its benefits in a way they find fair, understandable and under their control?

5 · FIVE QUESTIONS WE ANSWER TOGETHER

What tenants will decide

- **Fairness:** how should the money be shared between households?
- **Data:** what can the AI know, who sees it, how long is it kept?
- **Control:** should the assistant advise, or also switch appliances?
- **Access:** how do people without a smartphone take part fully?
- **Governance:** who runs the community, and how can decisions be challenged?